

Chapter 7 International Peace in the Crossfire between Nationalist Leaders and Intergovernmental Organizations

Abstract

Empirical studies on the effect of joint membership in intergovernmental organizations (IGOs) on international peace are inconclusive. Some studies narrow a general type of IGOs down to a specific one: Pevehouse and Russett (2006) analyze IGOs largely composed of democratic countries, and Boehmer, Gartzke, and Nordstrom (2004) consider the level of IGO institutionalization. These studies claim to find consistent and robust results that densely democratic and interventionist security IGOs are effective at fostering peace between countries. In this chapter, I demonstrate that nationalist state leaders constrain the pacifying effect of densely democratic and interventionist security IGOs because nationalist leaders prioritize national interests over the peace mandates of international bodies. Overall, this chapter suggests that the rise of nationalism is detrimental to IGOs' peacebuilding efforts.